

SPAN 550B · WEEK 5 · RUN OF SHOW

# THE RUN OF SHOW

≈ 8-10 MIN · THREE BEATS · TO READ ON STAGE

My roadmap for presenting Picabia's *Manifeste cannibale dada*. I don't summarize it: I **reactivate** it as **an event**, doing what the text orders. In **red bold**, what I read aloud.

---

## 1

1 · OPENING IN CHARACTER · REENACTMENT · ~2 MIN

### I DO WHAT THE TEXT ORDERS

I walk in without explaining anything and read the opening as a command:

**"YOU ARE ALL ACCUSED; STAND UP. THE SPEAKER CANNOT ADDRESS YOU UNLESS YOU ARE STANDING."**

I get the class to **stand** (as for the Marseillaise, before the flag, before DADA...), read the anthems passage in rhythm, then sit them back down with "Have you all sat down again? So much the better; that way you will listen to me more closely." I break character.

## 2

2 · THE READING · CANNIBALISM → CONSUMPTION · ~4 MIN

### I UNDO WHAT JUST HAPPENED

The manifesto treated them as an audience-commodity ("penned in like serious oysters"). I run through the litany of **nothing** and land on the last line (selling the paintings): Dada cannibalizes itself. I set up the contrast with **Andrade** / **anthropophagy** (digestion that transforms vs. digestion that annuls) and tie it to the money, death and seriousness in the text.

## 3

3 · INTERACTION + CLOSING · ~3 MIN

**CALL-AND-RESPONSE LITANY**

I say the noun (“your idols,” “your heroes,” “your artists”...) and the class answers “**nothing!**”. I close with the discussion questions (below) and show the web piece, where the manifesto devours itself.

**DISCUSSION QUESTIONS (CLOSING)**

- 01 If Dada “is nothing, nothing, nothing,” why does it need the audience on its feet? Can an anti-avant-garde negate everything without turning into a ritual, that is, just one more anthem?
- 02 The last line sells the paintings. Is Picabia cynical, or is it a lucid critique that every avant-garde ends up as merchandise? Where does that line fall today: NFT-art, the museum, the brand?
- 03 Picabia consumes and does not digest; Andrade digests in order to transform. Which of the two “cannibalisms” better describes Latin America’s relationship to European culture? Or do we need both?

Francis Picabia, “Manifeste cannibale dada.” Read by André Breton at the 3rd Dada soirée, Théâtre de l’Œuvre, Paris, 27 March 1920. Published in Dadaphone no. 7.

Oswald de Andrade, “Cannibalist Manifesto,” Revista de Antropofagia, São Paulo, 1928.

Presentation by Adri M · SPAN 550B, UBC.